

EPos 365

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Sandbox sales

A practice till for training staff. Sales rung on it never reach your books, though the stock still comes off the shelf.

What it is

Sandbox mode turns the till into a practice machine. A new starter can ring sales, take payment and print receipts exactly as they would for a real customer, and none of it touches your figures. No money is recorded, and nothing shows up in your reports or End of day. Stock is the one thing it does not hold back.

Turning it on and off

Open the menu from the button at the top right of the sales screen and choose Sandbox mode. Ctrl + Shift + S does the same thing if you would rather use the keyboard.

- Turning it on needs Manager level or above out of the box, and you will be asked for your PIN even though you are already signed in.
- That level is yours to set. Management → Users & security → Security has a line called Enable sandbox mode: lower it if you want a particular member of staff to run practice sessions themselves.
- Anyone below the level does not see the menu entry at all, and the shortcut does nothing for them. There is no way for a manager to approve it for them on the spot, unlike most other restricted actions.
- Turning it off is not restricted at all: no PIN, and any user can do it.
- A sale already on screen comes with you, whichever way you are going. The till asks first and says plainly what the sale becomes, so an order rung on the wrong till does not have to be typed again.

While sandbox mode is on, a SANDBOX MODE badge sits at the top of the sales screen, next to the menu button. Tap the badge to go back to the live till. No badge means you are already on it.

The way out is the badge rather than the menu because the menu is closed while sandbox mode is on. The badge is on screen for exactly as long as there is a practice till to leave, so it is always there when you need it.

If your shop has no use for a practice till, turn the whole feature off under Settings → Order & payment → Enable sandbox (training) mode. The menu entry disappears and the shortcut stops working for everyone, including administrators. It is on when the till is installed.

What changes

On the practice till	Why
Cash is the only payment method	Card and account payments would pull in real terminals and real customer balances.
Stock is deducted, as normal	Goods handed to a trainee have left the shelf. A count that ignored them would drift away from what is actually in the shop.
Receipt numbers start with SBX-	Practice sales never use up one of your real receipt numbers, so there are no gaps in them.
The main menu is blocked	Management, Settings and End of day cannot be reached from a practice till.
A Sandbox sales button appears in the top bar	With the menu blocked, this is the only way to review practice sales.

Where practice sales show up

Location	Practice sales included?
Sales history	No
Reports	No
End of day / Z-report	No
Stock levels	Yes, deducted like any sale
Sandbox sales screen	Yes, and only here

Stock still comes off the shelf

Ring up six bottles and hand them over, and six bottles have left the shop. The count drops by six, and your low-stock warnings react exactly as they would to a real sale. If training did not take stock off, your counts would drift further from the shelf every time somebody practised.

If nothing actually left the shop, say a trainee just tapping through the screens, put the count back in Management → Stock afterwards.

The till also assumes whatever expires soonest goes out first. When it works out what is left on the shelf it counts the batches dated furthest ahead as the ones remaining, so an expiry warning always points at the nearest date. What matters is the expiry date, not when the delivery arrived. A later delivery with a shorter shelf life is used up before an earlier one that keeps longer. Practice sales count towards this the same as real ones.

The till is assuming, not checking. It has no way of knowing which pack a member of staff actually reached for, so the warnings are only as good as the rotation on the shelf.

Reviewing and clearing practice sales

Tap Sandbox sales in the top bar. Two buttons live there that you will not find anywhere else.

Delete all sandbox sales clears the practice sales in the period currently on screen, not everything ever rung. Your real sales are never touched, and it cannot be undone.

Add this sale to live DB moves one practice sale into your real books. You want this only when a genuine customer sale was rung by mistake while the till was in sandbox mode.

What happens to the receipt number

Adding a practice sale to live gives it a fresh number from your real receipt numbering, and the old one is written over. Nothing keeps a copy of it. Someone holding SBX-26-200-000001 is holding a number that no longer exists on the till, and searching for it finds nothing. The sale might now be 26-200-000002. The digits moved as well, so it is not the old number with the SBX- stripped off.

Reprint the receipt and give the customer the new one. Stock does not change, because it came off when the sale was originally rung. None of this can be undone.

Finding a sale after you have added it to live

It disappears from the Sandbox sales screen as soon as you add it, because it is not a sandbox sale any more. Look for it in Management → Documents, alongside your real sales.

The number is the only thing that changed, so there is plenty left to go on. If the sale had a customer on it, the quickest way in is the Customer filter: pick the name and the list drops to that customer's sales. A walk-in sale has no customer attached, so that filter will not help there.

Otherwise go by date. Set the Period to the day the sale was originally rung rather than the day you added it, since the sale keeps its own date and time. The time, the total and the ID column are all untouched as well.

Watch the dates while you look. The new number is issued against today, but the sale is still dated when it happened. A sale rung on Monday and added to live on Friday gets a Friday-style number while sitting under Monday in the list. Search Monday.

Everyday use

- Turn it on for training and off again as soon as you are done. A till left in sandbox mode takes no real money, and every sale rung on it is thrown away.
- Look for the SANDBOX MODE badge before serving a customer.
- Clear practice sales now and then so the Sandbox sales screen stays readable.
- The two tills share one product list, one price list and one set of staff, so changing a price changes it for both.

Low stock warnings

The till tells you what is running out, so you notice before a customer does.

Where the warnings appear

A red badge on the menu button counts everything needing attention. Open the menu and it takes you to Stock alerts, where each product is listed with the reason it is there.

The same products are highlighted in Management → Stock, in a column called Needs attention. It is one list shown in two places.

When a product counts as low

Each product is judged against a threshold. If the quantity on hand is at or below it, the product is flagged. At or below, not under: with a threshold of 5 and 5 on the shelf, that is already the moment to reorder rather than a near miss.

Out of stock always counts, whatever the threshold says.

Setting the level

There are two places to set it, and a product only needs one of them.

- Settings → Order & payment → Items has Low stock threshold. This covers every product that has no figure of its own.
- Management → Products, editing a product, has Low stock threshold (optional). Fill it in and that product ignores the shop-wide figure.

The shop-wide figure starts at 0, so out of the box you are only warned once something has actually run out. Raise it and every product without its own figure starts warning at the new level, so expect the badge to jump the first time you change it.

Turning it off for a product

Some products have no shelf to run out of. Services, gift cards and open-price items will sit at zero for ever and warn for ever.

Edit the product and switch Low stock alerts off. Clearing the threshold box will not do it: an empty box means fall back to the shop-wide figure. The switch is what says never. Expiry warnings are unaffected either way.

Products marked inactive never appear either, since you cannot sell them anyway.

Choosing a number

The useful threshold is however much you sell while a delivery is on its way, plus a little. A line that sells two a day on a weekly order wants a threshold nearer fifteen than three.

Setting it too high is the more common mistake. Every product over its threshold sits in the badge count, and a badge showing forty is a badge nobody reads.

Expiry dates

Record what arrived and when it goes off, and the till warns you before it does.

Recording dates as a delivery is booked in

The usual place is the purchase itself. In Management → Documents, add a Purchase document for the delivery, and each line has an Expiry date (optional) field alongside the quantity and cost.

Saving the purchase adds a dated line to the expiry register by itself, noted against the purchase number so you can see where it came from. The date is typed once, while you have the box in your hand, and the purchase doubles as the record of what arrived and how long it was good for.

The field only appears on purchases. A sale, refund, return or write-off has no delivery date to record, so you will not see it there.

Dates are picked up the first time a purchase is saved. Going back into a saved purchase later will not add the delivery to the register a second time.

Record whichever date is printed on the pack, whether that is a use by or a best before. The till treats them the same and just counts down to it.

Recording a date afterwards

When a delivery was booked in without dates, or arrived before anyone was recording them, Management → Stock has an expiry entry flyout on the product: how much and the date on it.

Adjusting a product's quantity has the same field, and it dates only the units the change adds. It is ignored when the quantity stays the same or goes down, since nothing new arrived to date.

Either way, a product can hold several entries at once, which is normal when a new delivery lands before the last one has sold through. The older date carries on warning you after the newer stock arrives.

Nothing forces you to record dates at all. A product with no entries simply never raises an expiry warning.

When the warnings start

Warnings begin a set number of days before the date, and there are two states. Expiring soon means the date is coming up inside that window. Expired means the date has passed.

- Settings → Order & payment → Items has Expiry warning (days), which starts at 3 and covers every product without its own figure.
- Management → Products, editing a product, has Expiry warning days (optional) for anything that needs longer or shorter notice.

Three days suits chilled food. For a frozen or ambient line you would rather shift a fortnight early, set a longer figure on that product rather than raising the shop-wide one, or everything else starts warning far too early.

Expiry outranks low stock

A product can be both low and near its date. You will see the expiry reason, because that is the one with a deadline on it.

The order is worst first: expired, then expiring soon, then low. The top of the list is always the thing to handle first.

What the wording on screen means

The badge on the menu button counts everything at once, in the form 4 item(s) need attention: 1 expired, 2 expiring soon, 1 low on stock.

In Management → Stock, the Needs attention column is more specific. 6 expiring 17 Aug means six units are covered by an entry dated the seventeenth. Expired 6 on 10 Aug means that date has already passed.

Open a product's expiry entries and each one carries its own status.

- in 5d counts down to the date. It turns amber once inside the warning window.
- Expires today and Expired 3d ago speak for themselves.
- Assumed sold means stock on hand no longer reaches this entry, so the till has concluded it went out. It stops warning but stays on record, and comes back by itself if a recount puts the stock back up.
- Cleared means the entry has been closed off, either because somebody ticked it off or because the product hit zero and the till closed its open entries automatically. Unlike Assumed sold, this one is permanent.

How overlapping deliveries are handled

Selling something does not change what you recorded. Sell six bottles and the stock count drops, but the entry still says six arrived on that date. The till cannot know which pack actually went over the counter.

Instead it works backwards from the stock on hand, assuming the soonest-dated stock left first and counting whatever remains as the newest. So an older delivery that has sold through stops warning by itself, and the warning you see always points at the soonest date still covered by stock actually on the shelf.

That is an assumption, not a check. If staff hand over the newest pack because a customer reached to the back of the shelf, the till believes the older one is gone when it is still there. Rotating stock properly is what makes it true.

The Stock tab shows a Next expiry column, which is the soonest date stock still covers, so you can see what it has concluded.

Clearing an entry

When stock has been thrown away or sold through, tick the entry off. It stops warning but stays on record, so you can still look back at what was wasted last month.

If a product drops to zero the till clears its open entries by itself, since there is nothing left to go off.

Clearing is one way, however it happened. A cleared entry never warns again, so when stock comes back it needs a new entry with the new date. Assumed sold is the opposite: it is only the till reading the current count, and it undoes itself.

Slow moving stock

Which products are sitting on the shelf not selling, and how much money is stuck in them.

What it is for

Low stock warnings tell you what to reorder. This is the opposite question: what did you buy that nobody is buying back. Every one of those lines is money sitting on a shelf instead of in the till.

Where to find it

- Management → Reporting has the full Slow moving report, with a period picker and filters for a single product or category.
- The Dashboard carries a shorter Slow moving card, showing the worst offenders at a glance.

What counts as slow

A product appears when it has stock on hand and has not sold for longer than the shop's slow moving period. That period is in Settings → Order & payment → Items, under Slow moving after (days), and starts at 90.

Retail generally uses somewhere between 90 and 180 days. The right number depends on what you sell: a delicatessen counting in weeks and a hardware shop counting in seasons should not use the same figure.

Reading the report

Rows are sorted slowest first, so the top of the list is the stock that has sat longest. The bar beside each row is the money tied up in it, which is quantity multiplied by what it cost you.

A long bar near the top is the row worth acting on: old stock and a lot of money in it. A long bar low down is simply an expensive product that still sells.

Products that have never sold at all appear too. Usually that is something ordered once that never found its customer.

What the period does, and does not, do

This is the part that catches people out. The period you pick does not decide which products are listed. Whether a product is slow is judged against its last sale across the whole of your history, not just the window on screen.

The period only fills in the sold in period column, which is there for context. So a product last sold two years ago still shows up with the period set to this month. That is the report working, not a mistake.

What is left out

- Products with nothing on hand. A line you have sold out of is not tying up any money.
- Inactive products, which you cannot sell anyway.
- Practice sales rung in sandbox mode, which never count as sales here.

Acting on it

The usual moves are to discount it, move it somewhere customers actually look, bundle it with something that does sell, or stop reordering it. The report will not tell you which, but it does tell you where the money is, and that is the part which is hard to see from behind the counter.

Worth a look monthly. Checked more often than that, nothing has changed since last time.

End of day

Close the register at the end of a shift and get a Z-report of the day's cash.

What it does

Closing the register locks in every sale, cash movement and payment since the last close. You get a numbered Z-report of the totals. Once closed, that period cannot be reopened or edited.

Opening it

Open the hamburger menu and choose End of day. If you are not already signed in as a manager, enter a PIN with access to it.

A quick totals check, without closing anything

Press X REPORT to print today's totals so far. It does not close the register. Use it any time you just want to see where things stand.

Counting the cash

Choose Cash out (yourself), Cash out all users, or Close register. The till works out how much cash it expects in the drawer, from sales, cash paid in and cash paid out. Type what you actually counted, and it shows the difference.

Close register also shows a breakdown of open transactions and each user's own totals, so you can see where the day's figure comes from before going ahead.

- A shortfall asks you to confirm. It does not block you.
- Extra cash does not ask anything.
- Leave the count blank and it still closes, just with no comparison shown.
- Cash out only records the count. It does not close the register, so use it as often as you like through the day.

Before you can continue

Finish or cancel any open order first. A parked, unpaid order blocks all three options: Cash out, Cash out all users, and Close register.

If you are closing only your own cash and a colleague still has sales in the same drawer, a notice tells you so. It just lets you know; you do not need to clear it before continuing.

After closing

The Z-report prints itself, on the same printer your receipts come out of. You also get a confirmation on screen with the report number. There is no print button on it because the paper is already coming.

If the printer is off, out of paper or not set up, the confirmation says so and tells you to print it later. The register is still closed either way. Nothing is lost, and the count is not affected.

To print one again, open the History tab on the same screen, find it in the list, and choose Print selected report. That works for any past report, any time, not just the one you have closed.

Turn on the Z report (end of day) toggle in Settings → Email → Reporting to have it emailed too. Every close then emails you a copy as well as printing the slip, which is worth having if the till's printer is the only other record.

Worth knowing

- Closing cannot be undone. There is no reopen.
- Only sales rung on this till get swept in. A shop running more than one till closes each one separately.
- Credit and on-account payments get swept in too, whether or not the customer has actually paid you back yet.

Cash In / Out

Log cash moving through the drawer outside of a sale, such as a float top-up or a trip to the safe.

What it does

Cash In / Out logs cash movements that are not a sale or a refund. Think a float top-up at the start of the day, or notes going to the safe. It does not close the register or start a shift, so use it as often as you need through the day.

Opening it

Open the hamburger menu and choose Cash In / Out. If you are not already signed in as one, enter a PIN with access to it.

Recording an entry

Pick Add cash or Remove cash, type the amount, and add a note if you want one. The note is free text; there are no preset reasons. So what shows up later in reports depends entirely on what you type here.

The amount has to be more than zero. Beyond that there is no upper limit, and nothing checks it against what is actually in the drawer, so you can record a cash-out for more than the till holds. The screen keeps whichever direction you used last, since entries usually come in runs.

Today's entries are listed below, newest first, each showing who recorded it and when.

A separate Cash drawer button just pops the drawer open. It logs nothing, and has nothing to do with Add cash or Remove cash.

How it feeds End of day

Every open entry counts towards the expected cash figure at close: takings plus cash in, minus cash out. Closing sweeps everything still open into that Z-report, and from then on it stops affecting the running total.

Entries get swept by being open, not by date. So a register left open past midnight simply carries its cash-in and cash-out figures into the next day instead of resetting.

Worth knowing

- It is one drawer for the whole till, not one per user. Everyone's entries feed the same running total.
- Any authorized user can remove any amount with just a note, or no note at all. Keeping this permission to trusted staff is the only real control you have.
- There is no printed receipt for a single entry. The figures show up on the End of day report instead.

Credit payments

Take a payment against a customer's balance for sales that were put on account.

How a balance happens

There is no separate credit flow at checkout. Tender a sale with On account like any other payment type. That type is not marked as paid, so the sale sits unpaid against the customer until it is settled.

Opening it

Open the hamburger menu and choose Credit payments. If you are not already signed in as one, enter a PIN with access to it.

Taking a payment

Search for the customer. Their balance appears, added up from everything of theirs still unpaid. Pick a real payment type for what they are actually handing over, Cash by default, and type the amount.

Automatic applies the payment to their oldest unpaid sales first. Manual lets you tick specific sales to pay off instead, if a customer wants to settle one invoice rather than the whole balance.

Switching to Manual does not load their sales on its own. Press the reload button first, or the list sits empty with nothing to tick.

Either way, a sale is only marked paid once its full amount is covered. And you cannot take more than the customer actually owes; the screen will not let you.

Worth knowing

- A credit limit can be set on a customer's record, but nothing on the till stops a sale going through past it. It is a note for staff, not a block.
- On account is just another button at the payment screen, so a cashier can tap it by mistake on what should have been a cash sale.
- A payment taken here shows up on the End of day report mixed into whatever payment type was chosen for it, not as its own line. That report alone cannot tell you how much of today's cash was a fresh sale versus an old debt being paid off.

Users and permissions

Give each member of staff their own PIN, and decide what it lets them do.

Change the default PIN first

A new till starts with one Admin user and PIN 1234. Change it before the till goes live. Go to Management → Users & security → Users, edit Admin, and set a new PIN.

Adding a staff member

Go to Management → Users & security → Users and add a user. Give them a name and a PIN, then pick Staff, Manager or Administrator. That fills in an access level for you. You will not see the number day to day, but everything else in this section checks against it.

Signing in is PIN only, with no separate username. So every PIN on the till has to be different from every other one. The till rejects a PIN already in use.

The same screen sets an hourly pay rate, with a date it takes effect from and an optional note. Change it later and the old rate stays in a short history underneath, rather than getting overwritten.

What each level unlocks

Higher numbers can do more, and include everything a lower level can. A Manager can do anything a Staff member can. An Administrator can do anything a Manager can.

Action	Needs at least
Voiding an order	Manager
Opening Management	Manager
Opening Settings	Administrator
Turning on sandbox (training) mode	Manager
Releasing this till's licence	Manager
Resetting the database	Administrator

These are starting points, not fixed rules. Go to Management → Users & security → Security to raise or lower the level each action needs, one by one, if the defaults do not suit your shop.

You cannot hand out more than you hold yourself. A Manager setting up a new user cannot make them an Administrator; only an Administrator can create another Administrator.

Two people at the same level cannot edit each other, delete each other, or reset each other's PIN. Only whoever holds the single highest level in the shop can administer a peer at that same level.

Resetting a forgotten PIN

Go to Management → Staff passwords for the quick path: pick the user and set a new PIN, no old one needed. It only changes PINs, so use Users & security instead if you also need to change someone's access level.

There is no remote or self-service reset. If every Manager and Administrator PIN on a till is lost at once, contact support and quote the till's reference shown on the sign-in screen.

Staff hours

Go to Management → Staff hours, next to Users & security, to see every clock-in and clock-out on the till. A manager can correct one that was missed or wrong here. It needs the same Manager level or above as the rest of this section.

Worth knowing

- Deactivating a user works even with orders in their history; there is nothing to clear first. Deleting a user outright is the one blocked while they have orders on file. Deactivating is the usual way to retire an account instead.
- Sandbox mode is deliberately not something you can grant or take away here. It always needs Manager level or above, fixed in the till itself, unlike the other actions in the table above.

Print stations

Send kitchen and bar tickets to the right printer automatically, by what was ordered.

What a print station is

A print station is a named destination, like Kitchen or Bar, with one printer attached. Route a product to a station and every order for it prints a ticket for just that station, to that printer.

Anything not routed to a station falls back to the single Kitchen ticket printer, set in Settings → Print → Printer selection.

Setting one up

It takes two steps, on two different screens.

- Management → Print stations: create the station and give it a name.
- Settings → Print → Print stations: pick that station from the list and choose which printer it prints to.

A station created but never given a printer looks finished on the Management screen. It is not. Nothing routed to it will print until you choose a printer for it in Settings.

Once a station has a printer, click the gear icon next to it. This opens the same settings panel a receipt or kitchen printer gets: paper size, header and footer text, and a Print test page button to check it before relying on it. See the Printer setup guide for what each setting does.

Routing products to a station

Open a product or a category and look for its Print stations tab. Pick a station there, and every order for that item goes to it.

Routing a category routes everything in it. Give a product its own station and that choice wins over the category's.

Send an item to more than one station at once, if it needs a ticket in two places.

The warning to watch for

In Settings → Print → Print stations, a station missing its printer shows a small red warning mark, saying it won't print until you choose one. That is the only warning you get. A station in this state does not fall back to any other printer; it simply drops whatever is routed to it.

Check for that warning after any change to your printers or stations, before it costs you a lost order.

Worth knowing

- Settings → Print → Customize receipt has a Kitchen item text size setting (Normal, Large, Extra large). It only affects kitchen tickets, not the customer's receipt.
- There is no reprint button for a kitchen ticket once it has gone to the printer.

Printer setup and your receipt

Pick a printer for receipts, invoices and the kitchen, and choose what prints on them.

Before you start

Install the printer in Windows before it will show up here. Plug it in and install its driver first. Settings → Print picks from whatever Windows already knows about.

Choosing a printer

Settings → Print has three sub-tabs: Printer selection, Print stations and Customize receipt. This guide covers the first and third. Print stations, for routing kitchen and bar tickets to different printers, has its own guide.

Printer selection has three rows: Print receipt, Print kitchen ticket and Print invoice. Each gets its own printer from the dropdown, so they do not have to be the same machine. A red mark next to a row means nothing is chosen yet.

Pick a printer, then click its gear icon to open the settings: printer type, paper size, header and footer text, number of copies, and the cash drawer.

Windows printer or Generic / Text only

Windows printer suits anything with a proper Windows driver. It gets nicer formatting and lets you choose a paper size of 58mm, 80mm or A4. Your logo prints automatically, nothing to turn on.

Generic / Text only suits a basic thermal printer with no real driver. It sends plain text instead, sized by characters per line rather than a paper size. A shop only ever needs one of the two; switching printer type decides which settings you see.

A Print logo switch appears only for a Generic printer, but right now it does nothing. That kind of printer cannot print an image yet, switch on or off.

Testing it

Click Print test page, in the same panel, to send a real print with your current settings. Check it before trusting it to a customer.

Opening the cash drawer

Turn on Open cash drawer on a printer and it pops the drawer every time that printer prints. The exact code differs by printer, so use Find my command: pick your printer's make and model, try each code it offers until the drawer opens, then save that one.

More printer settings

An Advanced tab in the same panel holds further options: cutting the paper automatically, how many blank lines to feed before it cuts, the character set, and, for a Windows printer on roll paper, printable margins. A receipt printer also gets its own barcode option there. Most shops can leave these at their defaults.

Customizing the receipt

Settings → Print → Customize receipt covers what appears on it: currency and decimal places, whether tax totals and the tax name print, which customer details show when a customer is attached to the sale, and an address format you can build from tokens with a live preview.

Your shop's own name, address and logo live separately, under Management → My company.

Email and scheduled reports

Have reports and your end of day emailed to you automatically, instead of only ever printed.

Setting up outgoing email

Settings → Email → General asks for a mail server: host, port, whether it uses SSL, and a username and password to send through. It works with any ordinary SMTP provider, not just one. Some, Gmail included, need an app password rather than your normal one before they accept a login like this.

The same screen has a Bcc field for anyone who should quietly get a copy of every email the till sends. It also has default Subject and Message text, used to fill customer-facing emails like a receipt when nothing more specific is set for them.

Click Send test email to save what you have entered and send a message to that same address, so you can check it works before relying on it.

Choosing what gets sent

Settings → Email → Reporting has a Report selection list covering most reports on the till: daily sales, best sellers, stock movement and more. Tick whichever ones you want emailed. Its own Subject and Message fields are just for these scheduled report emails, separate from the general ones on the previous screen.

Those two boxes come filled in with wording that already uses placeholders, so you can see the syntax rather than guess at it. Edit around them: %shop%, %address%, %phone%, %taxnumber%, %user%, %date%, %time%, %datetime%, %reportnumber% and %attachments% are each replaced when the email goes out. Anything else you type between percent signs is left exactly as typed, so a stray one is harmless. Clear a box entirely and the till falls back to its own wording.

The Z report (end of day) and X report have their own toggles alongside it. Turn on the Z report and every register close emails it to you, on top of anything you print by hand.

Reports go out as PDF, Excel, or both, whichever you tick. There is no plain summary in the email body; reports are always attachments.

Sending on a schedule

Turn on Send email periodically and set an interval in minutes to send reports through the day, not just when the register closes, restricted to whatever business hours you set.

A period with nothing new to report sends nothing at all, unless you turn on Send if empty. A quiet morning with no email is normal there, not a sign something is broken.

Who receives them

One list of recipients covers everything you have selected. You cannot send different reports to different people; whoever is on the list gets whatever is ticked.

Worth knowing

- Scheduled sending only runs while the till's app is open. Close it and nothing goes out until it runs again.
- The till needs to be online when a report is due. If it is not, that send is simply missed, with no catching up later.
- A failed send in the background shows nowhere. It quietly tries again next time. Send test email is the only place a failure shows directly.

Importing products

Bring a product list in from a spreadsheet instead of typing every item by hand.

Getting a starting file

Export first, it is the easiest way to get a file in the right shape. Go to Management → Products → Export for a spreadsheet of what is already on the till, in the layout Import expects. Add your new products to it, or clear the rows out and start from a copy.

What the file needs

Name and Price are the only required columns. Everything else, code, barcode, group, cost, tax, stock quantity and a few more, is optional, filled in only where you have it. Columns can be in any order; the till matches them by header name.

Write a group as a path, such as Drinks/Cola for a subgroup. If a group's own name has a slash in it, write it as √ so it does not read as a path separator.

Price is the shelf price, tax included, unless you say otherwise. Put a 0 in the IsTaxInclusivePrice column and the till reads that row's price as the figure before tax and adds the tax on for you. Get this the wrong way round and every price in the file lands wrong by the tax rate, which is the one mistake here worth checking a couple of rows for after importing.

Importing it

Go to Management → Products → Import and pick the file. The till reads the whole file first, before changing anything. If it finds a problem that would stop the import part-way, it changes nothing at all and lists exactly which rows to fix, so you never end up with half a file applied.

If the file is fine, it imports and you get a report: rows it could not use, notes such as a tax rate that got created or defaulted, any new groups, and which stock quantities changed.

Editing the file in a spreadsheet

Be careful opening the file straight into Excel. It treats a long barcode as a number and shortens it: 2607071908099 turns into 2.60707E+12, and when you save, the real digits are gone. Two different barcodes can end up looking identical. Excel also drops leading zeros, so a code like 00123 becomes 123.

To avoid it, open Excel first and use Data → From Text/CSV instead of double-clicking the file. Before loading, set the Barcode and SKU columns to Text. LibreOffice asks the same question when it opens a CSV, and a plain text editor never changes anything.

If a barcode has already been damaged this way, the till refuses the import and tells you which rows. Export a fresh copy and make your changes again with the columns set to Text.

Building a nested group tree

The Group column builds nested groups for you. Write Drinks/Cola and you get a Drinks group with Cola inside it, created if they are not there already. If you want the group tree set up on its own, with no products in it yet, use the separate Import groups button next to Import and Export. It reads a file of group names with their parents.

What happens to items you already have

The till matches a row to an existing product by its code first, then by its name and group together. A match updates that product instead of creating a second one, so running the same file again is safe and will not duplicate anything.

Leave the tax column blank and the product gets your default tax rate from Settings, falling back to a zero rate if there is not one.

Each barcode can belong to only one product. A barcode already on a different product, or the same barcode on two rows in the file, stops the import before anything changes, with the rows named so you can fix them. A barcode added to a product that already has it is simply left as it is.

Worth knowing

- There is no undo once an import has gone through. A file the till refuses changes nothing, but a file it accepts updates real products, so check the prices and tax rates in it before importing.
- You do not need an empty product list first. Import adds and updates alongside whatever is already there.

Promotions

Set a discount to run automatically on a product or category, on a schedule.

What you can set up

Go to Management → Promotions and add a promotion. Pick one or more products or whole categories, then choose either a percentage off or a fixed price that replaces the normal one. There is no buy-one-get-one or bundle offer yet, only these two.

Scheduling it

Run a promotion all the time, or limit it by a start and end date, a start and end time of day, and specific days of the week. Give it the same start and end time, midnight and midnight or any other matching pair, and it runs all day rather than not at all.

How it applies

Nothing needs pressing. Add a matching product to an order and the price adjusts on its own, as long as the promotion is active right now.

Type a custom price instead of ringing up a normal product, and it skips promotions entirely. There is no set price for one to apply against.

Worth knowing

- Promotions do not stack. Cover a product with both its own promotion and its category's, and only the one on the product itself applies.
- A promotion set on a category also reaches products in a subcategory underneath it, not just products filed directly in that category.
- On the receipt, a promotion looks exactly like a normal discount. Nothing marks a price change as coming from a promotion rather than a cashier's own discount.
- There is no report showing how much a promotion has saved or how often it applied. To track that, check the promotion's dates against your sales figures by hand.

Backing up and restoring your data

Keep a copy of everything the till holds, put it back if something goes wrong, and keep two tills in step.

Backing up by hand

Go to Settings → Database → Backup database and choose where to save it. It is a single file, everything the till holds in one place.

Backing up automatically

Turn on Automatic backups in the same screen and choose when: on every start, on every close, every so many hours, or any mix of the three. Leave the backup location blank and it saves next to the database itself, in a Backup folder.

Delete old backups automatically only works with your own backup folder set. Leave the location at its default and old backups are kept forever. Set your own folder instead, and you can also say how many days to keep them for.

There is no reminder if backups stop happening. If a folder gets deleted or a drive goes missing, nothing on screen tells you.

Restoring a backup

Go to Settings → Database → Import database and pick the backup file. You get a warning first: this replaces everything on the till, sales, products and settings included.

The till closes itself once the import finishes. Open it again afterward.

Before it changes anything, the till backs up what is currently on it, in case the import turns out to be the wrong file. If that safety backup fails to save, the import stops rather than risking your current data.

Moving a backup to a different till

This is the normal way to set up a replacement till: import an existing backup onto it. The till's own identity, its terminal number and licence, does not carry over. The new machine gets its own instead of clashing with the one the backup came from.

Keeping two tills in step

Import database replaces one till wholesale. If a shop runs two tills side by side and wants each to pick up what happened on the other, use Export changes and Merge changes instead, underneath it on the same screen. These add to a till rather than replacing it.

Export changes writes what has changed on this till to a file, meant for a USB stick. Take that file to the other till and use Merge changes there to bring it in. To keep both tills level, do this in both directions: export from each one, and merge the other's file into it.

Change the same row on both tills, and the more recent edit wins; the older one gets dropped, not kept anywhere for reference. A deletion only goes through if nothing on the receiving till still depends on that row. A sale of a since-discontinued product is the usual reason one gets held back instead.

A merge goes through in full, or not at all. If something in the file cannot be applied, nothing on the till changes, and you are told what went wrong rather than left to guess.

Worth knowing

- Import database only takes a .db file this app made. It also rejects a file from a newer version of the app than what is installed.
- Restoring is a full replace, not a merge. Anything rung up since the backup was taken is gone once you import it.
- Export changes writes a .possync file, a different format entirely, and only Merge changes reads it back in. The two pairs, Backup/Import and Export/Merge, do not mix.
- Export changes and Import database are not the same thing, and picking the wrong one matters: import wipes out a till's own trading, merge only adds to it.